

Incarnation



A baby asleep in a feeding trough, straw on the ground, ordinary wood. Glory, taking a nap.

OPEN PART III BY SAYING

Everything before this asked why we need a Savior. These weeks answer with a Person. Incarnation through covenant: He came, He announced, He saved, He died, He stands between, He bought, He made peace, He canceled the debt, and He bound Himself by blood.

OPTIONAL, THREE MINUTES

If the group has been here for the earlier weeks, take three minutes. Ask, in one sentence, why we could not fix what sin, death, wrath, judgment, and condemnation described. The answer to listen for is not 'try harder.' We were guilty and dead. Then open the manger. The Son took flesh to do what we could not. He came to die.

Before you gather

- Read Day 10, Incarnation, in The Visual Gospel. Do not reteach the essay.
- Read Hebrews 2:14–18 in your Bible. The excerpt below is only a backup.
- Your people should already have answered the day's reflection questions. Do not ask those again.
- Leave with a name. The missional challenge only works if someone is named before you pray.

1 • ICEBREAKER • 7 MIN

Open the room

What is the most ordinary place you met someone who mattered?

Leader. Ordinary places. The manger is one. Do not ask for a favorite Christmas memory. Then open Hebrews 2. Flesh was required for the cross. Say that passing is allowed, especially the first few weeks.

2 • THE WORD • 8 MIN

See it, then say it

IF YOU NEED THE WORDS

Say: The eternal Son took a real human body. He came to die, and this was never a backup plan.

DEFINITION, FROM THE BOOK

The incarnation is the act of the second person of the Trinity, the eternal Son of God, assuming a full and true human nature, becoming fully God and fully man in one person, Jesus Christ, to accomplish the work of redemption.

IN THE ORIGINAL LANGUAGE

Greek sarx — flesh. The Word became flesh, a real human life.

MEMORY VERSE · JOHN 1:14

And the Word became flesh and dwelt among us, and we have seen his glory, glory as of the only Son from the Father, full of grace and truth.

Together, open the flashcard for Incarnation. Say the word, the definition, and the verse once. Then put the phone away.

3 · OPEN THE BIBLE · 15 MIN

Hebrews 2:14–18

Hebrews 2 says why the Son had to share our flesh and blood: to die, to break the devil's power, and to be a priest who has suffered. Ask the text. Do not settle for a seasonal feeling. Do not reteach the journal.

Since therefore the children share in flesh and blood, he himself likewise partook of the same things, that through death he might destroy the one who has the power of death, that is, the devil, and deliver all those who through fear of death were subject to lifelong slavery. Therefore he had to be made like his brothers in every respect, so that he might become a merciful and faithful high priest in the service of God, to make propitiation for the sins of the people. For because he himself has suffered when tempted, he is able to help those who are being tempted.

Have two readers if you can. Bibles open. The excerpt is only here so a forgotten Bible does not stop the night.

From the passage

1. Why did the Son have to share our flesh and blood? Name every reason these verses give. **CORE**

Leader. To die, to destroy the one who had the power of death, to deliver people enslaved by the fear of death, and to become a merciful and faithful high priest who makes propitiation for sins.

He came to die. Incarnation is for salvation.

2. Verse 17 says He had to be made like His brothers in every respect. What is missing if Jesus only seemed human?

Leader. No real death, no real temptation faced, no real priesthood, no propitiation. A costume cannot shed blood. He is the God-man, fully God and fully man, one person. Not God in a disguise.

4 · AROUND THE ROOM · 20 MIN

A conversation this chapter did not assign

3. John 1:14 says the Word became flesh and dwelt among us, and we have seen His glory. What does a manger say that a throne by itself could not say?

Leader. The Son came near, into hunger, night, and an ordinary feeding trough, and His glory was full of grace and truth. He did not stop being God there. Nearness serves redemption. It is not a mood.

4. Hebrews 4:15 says we have a high priest who was tempted as we are, yet without sin. Why does that matter on a hard week? **CORE**

Leader. Help comes from a real man who suffered and did not sin. Do not imply that He sinned. The text says the opposite, and that is why His help is clean and His blood is enough. He is able to help those who are tempted.

5. Where do we treat Jesus as an idea or a mood instead of the God-man who lived, died, and rose?

Leader. Prayer that never speaks to Him. A gospel with no body on the cross and no risen body. Worship that wants a feeling more than a King. He is worthy. We are sent because He is Lord, not to have a meaningful experience.

5 · SAY IT · 5 MIN

In one sentence

God the Son took on flesh so He could die and rise as the substitute for sinners.

Ask for two volunteers, not the whole circle. They may look at the sentence, then try it without looking. Clumsy and true is the goal.

6 · THIS WEEK · 5 MIN

Missional challenge

Before next week, carry this word to someone far from Jesus — a neighbor, a classmate, a coworker, a friend. Do it with a real action and with a true sentence. Name the person before you pray.

Go where someone far from Jesus already is, a porch, a shift, or a kitchen. Say that God did not stay at a distance. The Son took on flesh to die and rise for sinners.

Leader. A text message does not finish this. Be present, be a neighbor, and talk about the God-man. A kindness that never names Christ is not the whole challenge. We go because Jesus is King and worthy. Next week, before the icebreaker, take one minute. Who went, and what happened? One sentence. No speeches.

7 · PRAY · 8 MIN

Pray these, and leave room for others

1. Lord Jesus, we worship You as God the Son and as the brother who took real flesh.
2. You suffered when tempted and did not sin. Help the one here who is being tempted.
3. Thank You for coming near to make propitiation. Send us out because You are King.

Before you stumble

This is the first week of Part III. Read that line before you start. Correct this kindly and clearly: He did not become God at Bethlehem or at His baptism. He is the

eternal Son who took a human nature. He did not stop being God in the manger. If someone says He was only a good teacher, do not leave that false gospel sitting. Hebrews 2:17 says He made propitiation for sins. If someone is grieving, do not rush past verse 18. The priest who suffered is the help in the text.

WITH STUDENTS

Ask, 'Could Jesus have saved us by staying in heaven and sending a message?' Make them answer from Hebrews 2, not from a slogan. The death required the flesh. He came to die.

IF YOU STILL HAVE TIME

Philippians 2:5-11. He took the form of a servant and became obedient to death on a cross. Then God highly exalted Him. Read the descent and the crown. Then worship. Worship is the point.